



Coco the Capybara

A low, round, bottom-heavy capybara with a blunt sewn-on muzzle, plump stuffed legs and a calm embroidered sleeping face — no safety eyes and no small plastic parts

Design Code NS 04

No plastic eyes

Intermediate

2.5-3 hours

Stitch counts verified

About 10.3 cm (4 in) tall standing on all four legs • ~5 cm (2 in) wide at the widest • squat and bottom-heavy, standing on her feet rather than her belly

Worsted #4 warm brown ~30 g • dark brown ~5 g • 3.0 mm hook • embroidered face, no safety eyes

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SAFETY — EMBROIDERED FACE, NO PLASTIC PARTS

Coco has no safety eyes and no small plastic parts, which makes the face safer than a safety-eyed toy. That does not make the finished toy suitable for babies: Coco is a stuffed toy with a sewn-on muzzle and sewn-on ears, and it has not been tested to a toy-safety standard such as ASTM F963 or EN 71.

Intended as a decorative item or a gift for a child old enough not to chew it. Check every seam — especially the muzzle and ears — before giving Coco to a young child.

Materials

- **Main yarn:** worsted weight (#4), warm brown, about 30 g. A smooth matte yarn shows the stitch texture best.
- **Face yarn:** worsted weight (#4), dark brown, about 5 g, for the closed eyes, nose and mouth. Use the same weight as the main yarn.
- **Hook:** 3.0 mm (US C-2 or D-3). The gauge is written for this hook.
- **Eyes:** none. The sleeping face is embroidered — no safety eyes.
- **Also needed:** polyester fiber filling about 5–8 g; yarn needle; stitch marker; pins. Pins matter: the muzzle and ears are pinned before sewing.

Gauge & size check

36 sc around measures about 52 mm in diameter when stuffed (4.5 mm per stitch, 4.3 mm per round).

Check it on the body after Rnd 6 — a stuffed tube, not a flat swatch. If your 36 sts measure wider than 52 mm, crochet more tightly or go down a hook size; a loose gauge will show stuffing.

Abbreviations — US terms

MR magic ring • ch chain • sc single crochet • inc increase (2 sc in one st) • invdec invisible decrease • sl st slip stitch • st(s) stitch(es) • Rnd(s) round(s) • FO fasten off • (n) stitch count at round end.

Construction at a glance

- **Spiral.** work in a continuous spiral — do not join and do not chain 1 between rounds. Keep a marker in the first stitch of every round. Work every stitch through both loops unless a note says otherwise.
- **One round blob.** head and body are both 36 stitches around with only a shallow waist between them — that is what makes Coco read as one round blob rather than a snowman. The legs are joined low at Rnd 4-5.

The techniques that make this pattern

- **1. The magic ring** — every piece begins with a magic ring. Pull the tail tight once the first round is complete.
- **2. Working in a spiral** — keep a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round and move it up. There is no seam and no join to count from.
- **3. The two-layer leg join** — hold a finished leg against the body with the pinched-flat top of the leg lying against the outside of the body. Insert the hook through BOTH the leg and the body stitch and work one single crochet; the leg edge and body stitch are treated as one stitch. They still count as one stitch each, so every count in the body table stays correct. Pinch the leg top flat first — a round, un-pinched top will not lie against the curved body and the join will pucker.
- **4. How the height adds up** — body Rnds 1-20 = $20 \text{ rnd} \times 4.3 \text{ mm} = 86 \text{ mm}$; legs lift the body $\sim 17 \text{ mm}$ (short 8/9-round legs) — total standing height $103 \text{ mm} = 10.3 \text{ cm}$.

Pinching the leg top

A 9-stitch leg top flattens to about 5 stitches across — pinch it down to a strip about 3 stitches wide and hold it while you join. The stitches you don't join bunch up inside, and that bunch makes the leg look plump rather than tubular. Don't keep the top flat and wide.

1 · Legs — make 4 (back legs stop at Rnd 8, front legs work Rnd 9)

Stuff the lower half of each leg lightly, leaving the top loose. Front legs join one round higher and need to be one round longer so all four feet reach table level.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Notes
1	6 sc in MR	6	all four
2	[1 sc, inc] x 3	9	all four
3	sc in each st around	9	all four
4	sc in each st around	9	all four
5	sc in each st around	9	all four
6	sc in each st around	9	all four
7	sc in each st around	9	all four
8	sc in each st around	9	BACK legs finish here
9	sc in each st around	9	FRONT legs only

Fasten off with a long tail for sewing. Before joining, pinch the whole 9-stitch top flat into a narrow strip about 3 stitches wide.

2 · Ears (make 2) & 3 · Muzzle (make 1)

Rnd	EAR — Instruction	Sts
1	6 sc in MR	6
2	[1 sc, inc] x 3	9
3	sc in each st around	9

Fasten off with a long tail, do not stuff — a shallow cup.

- **Muzzle finish:** fasten off with a long tail and stuff lightly, just enough to hold a dome; it should sit proud of the head when sewn on.

Muzzle — make 1

Rnd	MUZZLE — Instruction	Sts
1	6 sc in MR	6
2	[1 sc, inc] x 3	9
3	[2 sc, inc] x 3	12
4	sc in each st around	12
5	sc in each st around	12

4 • Body & head — one piece, legs joined in Rnd 4 and Rnd 5

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Notes
1	6 sc in MR	6	
2	inc in each st around	12	
3	[1 sc, inc] x 6	18	
4	3 sc, [1 sc, inc] x 3, 3 sc, [1 sc, inc] x 3	24	join the BACK legs
5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	30	join the FRONT legs
6	[4 sc, inc] x 6	36	full width — check gauge
7	sc in each st around	36	
8	sc in each st around	36	
9	sc in each st around	36	stuff the body FIRMLY
10	[7 sc, invdec] x 4	32	shallow waist
11	[7 sc, inc] x 4	36	head begins
12	sc in each st around	36	muzzle over R12–14
13	sc in each st around	36	
14	sc in each st around	36	eyes at R14–15
15	sc in each st around	36	ears at R15
16	[4 sc, invdec] x 6	30	
17	[3 sc, invdec] x 6	24	stuff the head firmly
18	[2 sc, invdec] x 6	18	
19	[1 sc, invdec] x 6	12	top up stuffing
20	invdec x 6	6	cinch closed

Cinch the remaining 6 stitches closed and weave the tail inside the body. Do not decrease the Rnd 10 waist further — a narrow neck cannot hold the head upright on this shape.

Joining the legs as you crochet Rnds 4-5

Work Rnd 4 and Rnd 5 as the plain increase rounds in the body table, but as you reach each leg position, hold a pinched-flat leg against the body and work the next 3 sc through BOTH the leg and the body together. Those 3 sc still count as 3 stitches of the round, so the stitch totals do not change — Rnd 4 ends at 24, Rnd 5 at 30.

Rnd 4 — the BACK legs (total 24 stitches): 1. Work the first 3 sc through a leg and the body together, then [1 sc, inc] x 3. 2. Work the next 3 sc through the second leg and the body together, then [1 sc, inc] x 3 to the end of the round.

Rnd 5 — the FRONT legs (total 30 stitches): work 7 sc, join a leg over the next 3 sc, work 10 sc, join a leg over the next 3 sc, work 7 sc to the end. That is $7 - 3 - 10 - 3 - 7 = 30$. The 7-10-7 spacing centres each front leg between the two back legs. Work the numbers exactly — if the front legs line up directly behind the back legs instead of between them, the footprint narrows and Coco tips. The correct spacing covers the deepest footprint this shape allows — about 65 mm across and 29 mm front to back. Hold the piece upside down and check all four legs sit square before you stuff the body.

The legs join low (Rnd 4-5) so every foot hangs about 17 mm below the body and Coco stands on her feet.

5 • Face & assembly

- **Muzzle:** stuff lightly and pin it to the front of the head over Rnd 12–14, centred, then sew all the way around with matching brown. It should sit proud of the head, not flush. Centering matters — the eyes go 6 stitches apart and a muzzle pinned even slightly off-center crowds one eye.
- **Eyes:** embroider — do not use safety eyes. With dark brown, work a shallow downward arc about 3 stitches wide on each side, at Rnd 14–15, 6 stitches apart, with a tiny tick angled down at each outer end. This closed-eye curve is what makes Coco look asleep.
- **Nose & mouth:** embroider AFTER the muzzle is sewn on, so the stitches sit on the finished curve. On the muzzle, work a small dark triangle at top center, a short vertical line down from it, and a soft curved mouth to one side.
- **Ears:** pinch the base of each ear so it cups forward, then sew at Rnd 15, about 5 stitches apart, angled slightly outward. Rnd 15 is a full 36-st round, so this puts the ears on top of the head where a capybara's belong.
- **Legs:** the legs were joined during Rnd 4–5 — there is nothing to sew. Just check each pinched 3-stitch strip is caught fully in the round.
- **Final shaping:** roll the finished piece gently between your palms to settle the stuffing into a round, bottom-heavy shape.

Designer notes

Why the legs join so low.

Back legs (8 rnd, ~34 mm) join at Rnd 4, only 17 mm above the base; front legs (9 rnd, ~39 mm) join at Rnd 5, 21 mm up. Different lengths, same result: every foot hangs about 17 mm below the body so all four land level. This is the most common failure on round-bodied animals.

Bottom-heavy by design.

Stuff the lower body firmly and keep the shape squat. Coco is meant to be one continuous curve from base to crown — she stands on her feet, not her belly.

Before you sew — lay every component out and check

4 legs (2 back of 8 rounds, 2 front of 9) • 2 ears • 1 muzzle • 1 body & head, closed at the crown. The sleeping face is all embroidery — closed-eye arcs, a small triangle nose and a soft curved mouth.

Colorways

● Classic warm brown ● Soft grey ● Sandy beige ● Cocoa

Troubleshooting

- **Coco looks too tall.** almost always too many plain rounds. Rnd 12-15 is the straight head section the face is positioned on; adding 'just one more' round turns the shape into a tower and moves the face.
- **Coco will not stand.** check the join height, not the leg spacing. The legs belong on Rnd 4 and Rnd 5; joined any higher, they cannot clear the underside of the body and the belly rests on the table.
- **Coco tips forward or backward.** most often the front legs are lined up behind the back legs instead of between them — the Rnd 5 spacing must be 7 sc, 10 sc, 7 sc. If still tipping, stuff the lower body more firmly and settle weight back over all four feet.
- **Rocks back, front feet in the air.** all four legs are the same length and they cannot be. Front legs join at Rnd 5 (21 mm up), back at Rnd 4 (17 mm up); work the front legs 9 rounds and the back legs 8.
- **The head flops back.** the Rnd 10 waist is deliberately shallow at 32 stitches — do not decrease it further. A narrow neck cannot hold the head upright.
- **Small hole where a leg meets the body.** you joined a flat, wide leg top instead of a pinched one. Flatten the whole 9-stitch top into a strip about 3 stitches wide before joining, so the un-joined stitches bunch up inside.
- **Muzzle looks flat / stuffing shows.** stuff the muzzle just enough to hold a dome. If stuffing shows through the body, your gauge is too loose — 36 sts should measure 52 mm; crochet tighter or go down a hook size.

Why this pattern works — validation summary

Every stitch count in this pattern was checked with deterministic math (Crochet Pattern Checker): round-by-round production vs. consumption, stated counts, and every size claim against the stated gauge.

Check	Result
Body Rnds 1-20: 6 → 36 → 32 → 36 → 6 with leg joins counted	✓ verified
Leg-join arithmetic: Rnd 4 = 3+9+3+9 = 24; Rnd 5 = 7-3-10-3-7 = 30	✓ verified
Legs 9 sts, back 8 rnds / front 9 rnds	✓ verified
Ears 3 rounds (9 sts); muzzle 5 rounds (12 sts) — de-interleaved	✓ verified
Standing height 20 rnds x 4.3 mm + 17 mm legs = 103 mm = 10.3 cm	✓ verified
Muzzle face 24 sts ≈ 34.4 mm / rim 18 sts ≈ 25.8 mm	✓ verified
Waist [7 sc, invdec] x 4 consumes all 36 sts → 32	✓ verified

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SAFETY REMINDER

This pattern has not been tested to a toy-safety standard (ASTM F963 / EN 71). Although Coco has no plastic parts, finished items made for sale must be assessed by the seller against local toy-safety laws. Reinforce all sewn-on parts before giving to a young child.

Happy crocheting! Tag your makes with #NovalityStore and #CocoTheCapybara — thank you for supporting an independent pattern designer.

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